Sanitation Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1910.141)

Use on a walk-through of housekeeping, water supply, toilets, washrooms and eating areas at a permanent workplace.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.141

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A, and note the location of each defect.
2. When an item fails, record it, assign someone to correct it and recheck it before closing it out.
3. Manufacturer's instructions for fixtures and dispensers, other OSHA standards and site rules may add checks.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.141: Sanitation (Part 1910 Subpart J, General Environmental Controls) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-141-sanitation

SECTION A | Housekeeping, waste and vermin

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	General cleanliness Ref. 1910.141(a)(3)(i)	Work areas are clean as far as the work allows, with no avoidable buildup of dirt or debris.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Workroom floors Ref. 1910.141(a)(3)(ii)	Floors are dry where practicable; wet-process areas have working drainage and mats, platforms or false floors, or waterproof footgear is provided.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Floor and passageway surfaces Ref. 1910.141(a)(3)(iii)	No protruding nails, splinters, loose boards, or unnecessary holes and openings in floors, working places or passageways.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Waste receptacle condition Ref. 1910.141(a)(4)(i)	Receptacles for putrescible waste do not leak and can be thoroughly cleaned.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Waste receptacle covers Ref. 1910.141(a)(4)(i)	Each putrescible-waste receptacle has a lid that is solid and fits tightly, unless it stays sanitary without one.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Waste removal Ref. 1910.141(a)(4)(ii)	Sweepings, refuse and garbage are removed often enough that the area stays sanitary and no waste creates a health menace.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Vermin entry and harborage Ref. 1910.141(a)(5)	No signs of rodents or insects; openings and spaces that would let vermin in or shelter them are closed off so far as reasonably practicable.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Extermination program Ref. 1910.141(a)(5)	Where vermin have been detected, a continuing and effective extermination program is in place.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Potable and nonpotable water

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
9	Potable water supply Ref. 1910.141(b)(1)(i)	Potable water is available for drinking, washing, cooking, food and utensil washing, and personal service rooms.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Potable and nonpotable water						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
10	Portable drinking water dispensers Ref. 1910.141(b)(1)(iii)	Dispensers are clean, can be closed and have a tap.	☐	☐	☐	
11	Open drinking containers Ref. 1910.141(b)(1)(v)	No barrels, pails or tanks from which drinking water is dipped or poured, covered or not.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Shared cups and utensils Ref. 1910.141(b)(1)(vi)	No common drinking cup or other common utensils in use.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Nonpotable outlet marking Ref. 1910.141(b)(2)(i)	Every nonpotable outlet is posted or marked as unsafe and not for drinking, washing or cooking.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Backflow protection Ref. 1910.141(b)(2)(ii)	Nonpotable systems are built so nothing can backflow or backsiphon into the potable supply.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Nonpotable water use Ref. 1910.141(b)(2)(iii)	Nonpotable water is not used to wash people, cooking or eating utensils, or clothing.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Toilet facilities						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
16	Number of water closets Ref. 1910.141(c)(1)(i)	For each sex, the water closet count meets Table J-1 for the most employees of that sex present at one time on a regular shift.	☐	☐	☐	
17	Separate or single-occupancy rooms Ref. 1910.141(c)(1)(i)	Toilet rooms are separate for each sex, or are single-occupancy rooms that lock from the inside and contain at least one water closet.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Privacy compartments Ref. 1910.141(c)(2)(i)	Each water closet is in its own compartment with a door and partitions high enough for privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Sewage disposal Ref. 1910.141(c)(1)(iii)	No leaks, overflows or backups from the sewage disposal method that could endanger employees.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Mobile crews and unattended locations Ref. 1910.141(c)(1)(ii)	Where this exception is relied on, transportation to nearby compliant toilet facilities is immediately available.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Washing facilities and showers						
No.	**Check item**	**What to look for**	**OK**	**Defect**	**N/A**	**Notes**
21	Washing facility condition Ref. 1910.141(d)(1)	Sinks and washrooms are clean and sanitary.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Lavatories available Ref. 1910.141(d)(2)(i)	Lavatories are available to employees at the workplace.	☐	☐	☐	
23	Lavatory water Ref. 1910.141(d)(2)(ii)	Each lavatory runs hot and cold water, or tepid water.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Hand soap Ref. 1910.141(d)(2)(iii)	Hand soap or a similar cleansing agent is stocked at the lavatories.	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION D | Washing facilities and showers

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
25	Hand drying Ref. 1910.141(d)(2)(iv)	Individual cloth or paper towels, air blowers, or clean continuous cloth toweling are stocked and working near the lavatories.	☐	☐	☐	
26	Number of showers Ref. 1910.141(d)(3)(ii)	If showers are required by another standard: one shower for each 10 employees of each sex, or fraction thereof, who must shower on the same shift.	☐	☐	☐	
27	Shower soap Ref. 1910.141(d)(3)(iii)	Body soap or another cleansing agent is available near the showers.	☐	☐	☐	
28	Shower water supply Ref. 1910.141(d)(3)(iv)	Showers have hot and cold water feeding a common discharge line.	☐	☐	☐	
29	Shower towels Ref. 1910.141(d)(3)(v)	Each employee using a shower gets an individual clean towel.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Change rooms, clothes drying, eating areas and food

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
30	Change rooms Ref. 1910.141(e)	Where protective clothing is required by another standard because of possible toxic contamination, change rooms have storage for street clothes and separate storage for protective clothing.	☐	☐	☐	
31	Drying work clothes Ref. 1910.141(f)	Employer-provided work clothes that get wet or are washed between shifts are dry before reuse.	☐	☐	☐	
32	Eating and drinking locations Ref. 1910.141(g)(2)	No one eats or drinks in toilet rooms or in areas exposed to a toxic material.	☐	☐	☐	
33	Food waste receptacle material Ref. 1910.141(g)(3)	Food waste receptacles are smooth, corrosion resistant and easily cleanable, or disposable.	☐	☐	☐	
34	Food waste receptacle emptying Ref. 1910.141(g)(3)	Receptacles in use are emptied at least once each working day and are not overfilled.	☐	☐	☐	
35	Food waste receptacle lids Ref. 1910.141(g)(3)	Receptacles have a solid lid that fits tightly, unless they stay sanitary without one.	☐	☐	☐	
36	Food and drink storage Ref. 1910.141(g)(4)	No food or beverages stored in toilet rooms or in areas exposed to a toxic material.	☐	☐	☐	
37	Food service hygiene Ref. 1910.141(h)	Where food service is provided, food is wholesome, free from spoilage and stored and handled so it is protected from contamination.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME

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